



Susairaj



Grover

NEERAJ GROVER MURDER

ACCUSED: Maria Susairaj and Lieutenant Emile Jerome

CAUSE: JEALOUSY

DATE: May 6, 2008

PLACE: Mumbai

THE CASE: Susairaj, a small-time Kannada actor, befriended Grover, who was working with Synergy Adlabs. Her naval officer boyfriend did not like it. On May 6, he caught them together. Following a spat, Jerome stabbed and killed Grover. Later, they dismembered his body and set it on fire in Manor, Thane.

In post-modern India, a new *bharatiya nari* is emerging, one who is unshackling the traditional stereotypes to pursue material, professional and sexual ambitions with equal gusto. For the new Indian woman, granting sexual favours for professional gains is like drinking coffee, claims one counsellor attached to a large corporate. The same woman today can kill her husband or lover if he proves to be an inconvenient obstruction in the larger scheme of things. Adds Harish Shetty, social psychiatrist: "The women are saying that they can do what they want in a recklessly fast world. The walk of a woman has changed today, gone is the coy, shy woman. Women are demanding more of everything today, including intimacy. Having seen discrimination and abuse, women today want to hit back."

Be it a small-time actor or a high-profile socialite, pursuit of personal pleasures is the mantra of this 'Me Inc'. Last year, a high-profile business mag-

nate hired a detective agency to shadow his socialite-turned-fashion designer wife's movements. In April 2007, a city tabloid set the grapevine rolling with news of her hush-hush affair with her best friend's husband. The sms exchange nailed the couple and the enraged businessman asked her to leave the house. A series of denial-interviews later, the two couples are back to business again. Says matrimonial lawyer Mrunalini Deshmukh: "The ratio of men and women indulging in extra-marital affairs is 50:50. Ten years ago, it would be 70 per cent men in such relationships. The approach to life has changed. People believe that they have only one life, so they must live it to the fullest. There is no 'we' left in a relationship; there's only 'I'."

Women are asserting themselves everywhere and pursuing their passions with a vengeance. At 17 per cent of the organised workforce in India, the number of women in the workplace has

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FILES

SHOWBUSINESS/ASPIRING CELEBRITIES



Moon Das

VICTIM: Mother Kanan Das and uncle Vikas Sarkar of aspiring actor Moon Das
ACCUSED: Avinash Patnaik
CAUSE: JEALOUSY

DATE: November 22, 2007

PLACE: Mumbai

THE CASE: Aspiring model and actor Moon Das called off her relationship with boyfriend Avinash Patnaik from Rourkela. He could not deal with rejection, drove down to Mumbai and shot her mother and uncle dead. When Das escaped after locking him in the apartment he shot himself dead.

PROFESSIONALS

VICTIM: Manju Pandey and her son

ACCUSED: Jitender Pandey

CAUSE: SUSPICION OVER EXTRA-MARITAL AFFAIR

DATE: March 30, 2008

PLACE: Delhi

THE CASE: Following a quarrel with his wife over her suspected affair, Jitender Pandey, 35, first threw his two-and-a-half-year-old son from their 2nd floor house in west Delhi's Kailashpuri. He then attacked Manju with a rod.



Roy

VICTIM: Shashi Roy
ACCUSED: Ashish Nandwana
CAUSE: JEALOUSY AND NO TO MARRIAGE
DATE: March 29, 2008

PLACE: Delhi

THE CASE: Jaipur-based Ashish Nandwana stabbed Roy after a fight in a Delhi guest house. The airhostess with Kingfisher Airlines had refused to marry him citing alcoholism. His friend Manoj Nandwana cleaned the blood and the duo then took Roy to hospital and reported a suicide bid. The hospital, however, called up the police.